Benjamin Saul McCulloch

Senior DevSecOps & Site Reliability Engineer · Cloud Security Lead

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SUMMARY

Senior DevSecOps, SRE and cloud security engineer with 15+ years of experience making Azure, AWS and GCP platforms secure, reliable and cheaper to run. Cut mean time to recovery by 65% and mean time to remediation by 70% on an enterprise tax platform processing millions of calculations a day, reduced cloud spend by 30%, cut release cycles from 30 days to 10, and led incident response that evicted active attackers. Now leading security, DevOps and AI at a multi-country company.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud & Platforms: Azure (AKS, Azure SQL, Cosmos DB, Front Door, App Gateway, Key Vault, API Management, Service Bus), AWS, GCP, Kubernetes, Helm, Docker, Proxmox, VMware ESXi, Linux (RHEL, Debian)

Security: Microsoft Sentinel, Defender XDR / Endpoint / Identity / Cloud, Purview DLP, Intune, Entra ID, Conditional Access, PIM, Okta, Duo, CrowdStrike, SentinelOne, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nessus, Qualys, Threat Modeling, Incident Response, Zero Trust

DevSecOps & IaC: Azure DevOps Pipelines, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, TeamCity, Octopus Deploy, SonarQube, Terraform, Azure Policy, Ansible, PowerShell DSC

SRE & Observability: SLOs and error budgets, Datadog, Dynatrace, Azure Monitor, Application Insights, Grafana, Prometheus, PagerDuty, Azure Chaos Studio, Elasticsearch

Compliance: SOC 2, ISO 27001, NIST CSF / 800-53, CIS Benchmarks, PCI DSS, HIPAA, Essential Eight, OWASP Top 10 / ASVS / LLM Top 10

AI & Languages: AI security and sandboxing, Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, PyRIT, local LLMs (Ollama) · Python, PowerShell, Bash, TypeScript, Node.js, Kotlin, C, SQL

EXPERIENCE

Lead of Cyber Security, Technical Accounts & DevOps · Salvo Software
Apr 2026 – Present · Remote

Remote engineering company with teams in Mexico, the USA and India. Joined to own DevOps and security; promoted to lead within months.

- Led the AI program: built a sandboxed ESXi/Debian environment for **50 developers** using bubblewrap isolation, ran local models on an NVIDIA Vera Rubin NVL72, added a fully logged backend for AI access and wrote the AI security framework, so developers adopt AI without exposing sensitive repositories or the host OS.
- Built Azure DevOps CI/CD and dashboards for three dev teams, cutting time between versions **from 30 days to 10 (3× faster)**, including the xmlpids client pipeline.
- Wrote a tool that scans every build for CVEs and alerts dev teams automatically, catching vulnerabilities before release.
- Built Python VIN data pipelines on a custom Linux server (self-service by year, make and model; output to database or emailed CSV), collecting **1,000 VINs/hour and 100,000+ to date** to test diagnostic hardware.
- Rolled out Intune, Defender, Conditional Access, Workspace SSO, FIDO2 MFA, 1Password and phishing simulations; handle all security incidents, stopping a handful of attacks and many phishing attempts.
- Cut costs by replacing paid SaaS with self-hosted Docker/Proxmox services and TypeScript tools; codified infrastructure with Terraform and Ansible across three clouds; built UniFi office networks with WireGuard and Tailscale.

Cyber Security Specialist (Freelance) · Affila Technology
Mar 2025 – Present · Remote

- Lead assessments, remediation and security roadmaps across **~5 client engagements** spanning Azure, AWS, GCP and on-prem.
- For MSP client UIDN, personally remediated every misconfiguration in their Microsoft 365 environment.
- Tested a client AI chatbot (Azure OpenAI, AWS Bedrock, PyRIT, OWASP LLM Top 10), found data-leak issues and drove remediation.
- Run penetration tests (Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Nmap, Metasploit, Kali) and scans (Nessus, Qualys, Defender for Cloud) mapped to NIST CSF and CIS.

UST · Client: Wolters Kluwer SureTax
Apr 2025 – Apr 2026 · Remote

Cloud tax engine processing millions of calculations a day for enterprise clients; SOC 2 and ISO 27001 compliant.

Senior Site Reliability Engineer
Sep 2025 – Apr 2026

- Cut **mean time to recovery by 65%** by stabilizing the Azure network and adding redundancy, backed by SLOs, error budgets, Datadog, Grafana and PagerDuty on-call.
- Traced recurring East US slowdowns to Microsoft Patch Tuesday maintenance causing Elasticsearch timeouts; built timeout compensation with the team so users stopped seeing errors.

- Reduced **Azure costs by 30%, then a further 25%** by removing unused resources, moving to on-demand environments and right-sizing AKS.
- Built automated failover across Azure SQL and Cosmos DB behind Front Door, validated with Azure Chaos Studio; delivered blue-green, zero-downtime releases every two weeks.
- Mentored about **15 engineers** on SRE, secure coding and incident response.

Senior DevOps Engineer Apr 2025 – Sep 2025

- Cut **mean time to remediation by 70%** with zero-downtime patching, runbooks and automated remediation.
- Added SonarQube, DAST, container, secret and dependency scanning as pipeline gates; enforced least privilege with Terraform, Azure Policy and Key Vault, automating SOC 2 and ISO 27001 checks.

Architecture and Optimization (Cloud Security) · Avertium Jul 2024 – Apr 2025 · Hybrid

- Secured Microsoft cloud and hybrid environments for **13 managed security clients** against CIS, Essential Eight, NIST CSF, PCI DSS and HIPAA.
- Led the breakthrough in a holiday intrusion at a large manufacturer: full network scans traced the entry point to a vulnerable third-party FTP service; blocked it across **12 sites** and the team evicted the attackers.
- Wrote Python scripts that audit Azure, AWS and GCP against CIS Benchmarks and generate reports.
- Deployed Entra ID, Conditional Access, PIM, Okta, Duo, Defender XDR, CrowdStrike, SentinelOne, Sentinel detections, Purview DLP and Intune/Autopilot hardening.

Senior Cloud & DevOps Engineer · UST · Client: AvidXchange Apr 2021 – Jun 2024 · Remote

- Led enterprise monitoring with Dynatrace, Azure Monitor and Logic Apps automation, cutting recurring service failures from about one every 3 days to a handful a year (**~95% reduction**).
- Moved **18 legacy applications** to Docker and AKS with Helm and Azure Container Registry.
- Built reusable Terraform modules and Azure DevOps pipelines so teams could self-serve SOC-compliant infrastructure.
- Restored a failed production Logic App by tracing the root cause to a Microsoft platform update.

Earlier roles 2018 – 2021

- **DevOps Engineer, WSAudiology** (2021): automated RHEL deployments with Jenkins and Ansible; Prometheus and Nagios monitoring.
- **Software Specialist / DevOps Engineer, iTexico** (2020–2021): TeamCity and Octopus Deploy CI/CD for IIS and SQL Server; Azure Logic Apps.
- **DevOps Specialist, Muttual** (2019–2020): deployments, SQL Server and automation for an ASP.NET / C# platform.
- **G Suite & GCP Support Specialist, EPAM Systems** (2018–2019): supported Google's premier Workspace and GCP customers.

PROJECTS

- **Linux Sync** (open source): peer-to-peer Linux system sync with GTK GUI, mDNS discovery, QR pairing and SSH transport; built in under a day. github.com/Benjamin-Saul-1989/Linux-Sync
- **PortBuster** (open source): Python CLI to query registered ports for TCP/UDP availability and descriptions.
- **ADS-B Business Card** (in progress): custom PCB that detects aircraft on 1090 MHz and blinks an LED.

VOLUNTEERING

Volunteer Instructor, FAC (non-profit, Mexico City) · Jul 2025 – Present
Teach cybersecurity and self-hosting classes every second Saturday, in English and Spanish, to 10–30 students.

Volunteer Maker, Enable the Future
3D-print prosthetic hands for children.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Advanced Diploma, Security and Networking · TAFE SA, 2013
Certificate IV, Electronics and Computer Systems · TAFE SA, 2012

Microsoft Certified Solutions Expert (MCSE), 2013 · CCNA Security, 2013 · CCNA Routing and Switching · Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), 2012 · Microsoft Technology Associate (MTA), 2012

Languages: English (native), Spanish (conversational), Japanese (elementary)

WHAT MANAGERS SAY

"Demonstrated a highly collaborative and solution oriented mindset... always proactive and involved when challenges arose." Esteban Fernandez Cuevas, UST Delivery Manager (direct manager)

"Played a pivotal role in implementing Dynatrace... a significant asset to any team." Ashok Ganpathi, Engineering Leader, UST (direct manager)

"Never brings a problem to the table without also bringing a solution." Nathan French, CISSP, Avertium

15 recommendations on LinkedIn. References and contact details available on request.